STEIN'S TOTAL WELLNESS ©™©

NO. 01

A STEIN'S TOTAL WELLNESS WORKBOOK

SEVEN MINUTE WELLNESS©™©

Total TRANSFORMATION in Less Time Than Your Morning Shower.

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HERE'S WHAT THE WELLNESS INDUSTRY DOESN'T WANT YOU TO KNOW!

The reason you can't get your shit together is not complicated!

I've spent over twenty years in the work, since I was 5 years old — as a clinician, a coach, a speaker, a student of every modality you can name and several you've probably never heard of. I have done it ALL. The frameworks. The modalities. The "sacred containers." The silent retreats. The VIP intensives. The plant medicine ceremonies. The certifications upon certifications. And after all of that, I can tell you: it all circles around a truth that is, at its core, so simple, so clarifying, so essential, that I genuinely believe it could reshape the entire personal development landscape if people JUST EFFING PAID ATTENTION TO IT!

OKAY. Here it is. The whole thing.

You have a small number of ways that it's really important for you to feel about yourself. Like two or three. THAT'S IT. *Strong. Helpful. Important. Fun and adventurous. Smart. In control. Influential. Perfect. Part of something.* Whatever yours are. I call these **THEMES**. There are only about 5–9 ballparks, but it's tricky because the specific language matters — I've said to someone "Ah it seems like you want to feel important" and they say "NO THAT'S NOT IT AT ALL. I want to feel like I am relevant." Your particular language is the key that unlocks your particular BEING.

Each theme has a **DREAM VERSION** — an exaggerated, idealized aspirational self-concept of who you'd be if everything went perfectly. "I'm an emotional superhero who saves everyone." "I'm a world-class (insert arena here) who never drops a ball." "I'm so fun and magnetic that everyone wants to be around me at all times." You know yours somewhere, at least in the back of your mind. You've been chasing it your whole life. It's what you admire in other people, and what makes you feel moved when you see it in action.

Take a moment. Connect with what's arising. What is your dream self? The fullest, most ALIVE version of you? Write it below.

And each theme has a **NIGHTMARE VERSION**. "I'm a burden." "I'm a failure." "I'm boring and nobody actually wants me around." You know this one too. You just try not to say it out loud and sometimes it comes pouring out in an unhinged waterfall of self-hatred.

Now write down your nightmare self. The one you'd rather die than admit to sincerely. Take your time. Use extra paper if needed.

THE HARD PART

THE PARTS YOU'RE NOT GOING TO LIKE

(1) You — and I cannot stress this enough — spend your ENTIRE LIFE chasing the dream version and running from the nightmare version. That's it. And not just with the thing you're currently struggling with. With EVERYTHING. Your career. Your relationship. Your body. Your 2am existential spiral. Your inability to stop checking your phone. Your reaction to that one thing your partner said six weeks ago that you're still not over. ALL OF IT is downstream of two or three themes and your constant, dysregulated oscillation between their best and worst versions. If you don't believe me, you're not being honest with yourself or thinking about it clearly.

It's literally just this. I know. It sounds too simple. But that's what makes it BEAUTIFUL.

(2) Now I want you to really hear this next part. I'm going to be REAL with you right now, because this is one of the most important things I have EVER learned in over three decades of doing this work.

YOU ARE THE NIGHTMARE VERSION.

Not exclusively. Not as your totality. But you ARE it. You are the selfish one. The weak one. The needy one. The one who is too much. The one who isn't enough. Whatever yours is, you are that. It's in you. It's real.

The avoidance of this idea (with the occasional meltdown into the most exaggerated version of it, depending on who you are) — like for any average eight to ten year old who can't handle being the slightest bit bad at something or collapses into a puddle when their friend doesn't invite them to their birthday party — runs your life, whether you admit it or not.

And the reason it has so much power over you is NOT that it exists. It's that you refuse to hold it with any lightness whatsoever. You treat it like a bomb. So it acts like one. You cannot handle the POSSIBILITY, the uncertainty, that perhaps you're the kind of person who would have this problem.

THE WHOLE THING

HERE'S THE BREAKTHROUGH!

Wellness — ACTUAL wellness, the real kind, not the version they sell you in a twelve-week container — is just ACCEPTING THIS. In the REAL way. Not in a cute Instagram post about being "messy." And — this is important! — also not in a self-flagellating "I'M GARBAGE" way. In the real way. The one that lives between defensiveness and self-deprecation, where you just go:

> ***"Yeah. I'm needy. I'm also generous and caring. But I'm needy. That's in there. It's okay."***

Being a human is a package deal and the package includes some shit you don't love. The question isn't how to eliminate the nightmare version. You CAN'T. The question is whether you can hold it without it running your entire life. And THAT is where the real transformation begins!

A TRUE STORY

In case you're not aware of this, people who get into therapy and personal development are on average somewhat fucked up. I don't mean that as an insult; it's just that for the most part you don't get interested in psychology when your life is overall working well.

So in 2013, as one of my many attempts to fix myself, I went to a personal development workshop called Noble Man. Yes, that is actually what it was called.

I was supposed to be there as volunteer staff, but I ended up drawing a lot of attention to myself and being kind of a grandiose, minor-league emotional vampire. At some point I realized this and went to the leader of the course, a warm German woman named Britta, and apologized for causing issues.

> ***She said, "That's okay. You're just really needy."***

Something broke in me. She wasn't being mean. It was a completely straightforward observation — like "the sky is blue" — but tinged with love. I looked at myself and thought, "Huh. I am really needy. I guess that's fine. Better to just be straightforward about it than let it run me while pretending I'm not."

That was the moment I understood what actual self-acceptance looks like. You look at the worst thing you think you are and go "yeah, that's in there," and your whole nervous system SETTLES. This is one of the most important turning points in personal growth, and it's something you have to come back to over and over again.

THE PRACTICE

SURE, MAKES SENSE. BUT WHAT DO I DO ABOUT IT?

This is where everyone goes. And I find this question insanely annoying but I also love it, because it means you're ready to actually do work.

The hard part was never understanding. The hard part is practice. This entire thing — all of life, really — is a mindfulness practice where we work toward feeling how we want to feel as much of the time as possible, and where we learn to resource ourselves when we inevitably don't. It's the ongoing, daily, sometimes UNGLAMOROUS work of continuing to show up as who you actually are, fully, in a more sincere and embodied way. There is no shortcut. There is no hack. There is no module that gets you out of having to practice.

There are two specific dynamics that keep you stuck in the same patterns. This is the part that changes everything.

The first dynamic is a loop. You get inspired. You pursue the dream version — sign up for the course, start the diet, have the big conversation. You feel like THIS TIME is different. Then something cracks. You crash into the nightmare version. You get numb. You get frustrated. Enough time passes. Something inspires you again. Back to the beginning. This ebook might be step one of a new loop for you — I want to be real about that.

The practice with loops is opting out of the cycle at both ends. When you're in the inspired phase — chasing the dream version — you check yourself. You don't abandon the aspiration, but you ground it into something real and sustainable instead of something that validates your aspirational self-concept. This is what I call stepping into your developing self.

And when you're in the nightmare phase — crashed, feeling like exactly the thing you're afraid of being — you don't let yourself spiral insincerely into self-hatred. Instead, you find the humility to admit to someone that you're feeling this way, first of all, yourself. You say "I feel like a burden right now and I don't know what to do with that" instead of performing that everything is fine or collapsing into "I'm garbage." Both directions require the same thing: sincerity instead of performance.

The second dynamic is a bind — when parts of you want opposite things, when multiple themes are at odds or the exit door from a loop is calling you but the loop itself is pulling back. I want to leave but I love this person. I need help but asking means I'm weak. I want to be successful but if I actually go for it I might fail and that would prove I'm not good enough. I want to be honest but if I say the real thing I might lose them.

Every coach out there tells you to “just decide.” “Commit.” “Stop overthinking.” They cheerlead the side that SEEMS more empowered. But this is fucking stupid. IT DOESN’T WORK, because the suppressed part comes back. At 2am. During a fight. After three drinks. In the form of a behavior you swore you’d never do again.

The practice: don’t choose a side, at least not yet. Most important decisions in life are not 100/0. They’re 60/40 or 55/45. Maybe 70/30 at best. There are real parts of you on both sides, and if you prematurely collapse to one, the other WILL sabotage you. So you hold it. You engage with both sides. You make sincere guesses and see where they lead until you feel like you can move forward.

It’s important to understand that this is all very hard to change because these themes and their corresponding loops and binds didn’t come from nowhere. They came out of solutions to REAL problems you encountered when your identity was first taking shape around six to 10 years old. For example, the kid who learned that being helpful kept them safe became the adult who can’t stop saving everyone. These patterns are neurological. They’ve had decades of reinforcement. So no, reading an ebook is not going to undo them. But knowing where they come from helps you hold them with compassion instead of just white-knuckling your way through another failed attempt to change.

START HERE

Take a breath. Place one hand on your heart. What is ONE thing you’ve been avoiding about yourself — one thing you already know is true but haven’t fully let yourself see? Write it down. This is where the real work starts.

I’m sorry to tell you, but these changes don’t take seven minutes. They take the rest of your life. But it gets better as you go. And I believe — with everything I have — that this is the most important work a person can do.

Maximize Your Life. Monetize Your Trauma.©™©

— DR. AARON STEINBERG

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